PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY MARK SCHEME

2018 Exam-Style Practice Paper

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75 (1HI0/33)

Question 1: Inference from Source A (4 Marks)

Target: AO3 (4 marks). Award 1 mark for each valid inference, up to 2. Award 1 mark for each corresponding quote/detail, up to 2.

Sample Acceptable Inferences:

• Inference 1: Southern officials deliberately created impossible barriers to block Black citizens from exercising their constitutional voting rights.

- Detail from source: "Local registrars administer arbitrary 'literacy exams' that require Black applicants to interpret intricate constitutional clauses..."

• Inference 2: Black citizens faced economic reprisal and terrorism for attempting to register.

- Detail from source: "any Black citizen attempting to register risks immediate dismissal by their employer. Intimidation is omnipresent."

Question 2: Causal Explanation (12 Marks)

Target: AO1/AO2 (12 marks). Level 4 (10–12 marks): An analytical explanation showing a line of reasoning with clear links to the outcome, supported by accurate, detailed knowledge.

"One reason why Black Americans faced segregation and discrimination in the Southern states in the early 1950s was that federal judicial rulings provided constitutional backing for segregation." In 1896, the landmark Supreme Court decision in **Plessy v. Ferguson** established the 'separate but equal' doctrine. This legal precedent allowed Southern states to pass sweeping **Jim Crow** laws enforcing segregation in schools, public transport, and restaurants. *Therefore, federal judicial approval was a primary reason why Black Americans faced segregation and discrimination in the Southern states in the early 1950s because it legally shielded discriminatory state laws from constitutional challenges.*

"A second reason why Black Americans faced segregation and discrimination in the Southern states in the early 1950s was that Southern state authorities systematically disenfranchised Black voters." States introduced impossible literacy tests, requiring Black applicants to explain complex constitutional clauses, alongside **poll taxes** and grandfather clauses. This meant that by 1956, only **20%** of eligible Southern Black citizens were registered to vote. *Therefore, political disenfranchisement was a crucial cause of why Black Americans faced segregation and discrimination in the Southern states in the early 1950s because it prevented Black citizens from obtaining the democratic representation needed to challenge racist local policies.*

"A third reason why Black Americans faced segregation and discrimination in the Southern states in the early 1950s was that segregation was ruthlessly enforced through organized white violence and social terror." The **Ku Klux Klan** and White Citizens' Councils carried out lynchings, bombings, and economic intimidation, such as firing Black workers who tried to register. This campaign was reinforced by local police complicity and all-white juries who refused to convict white attackers. *Therefore, grassroots violence and state-level complicity were decisive reasons why Black Americans faced segregation and discrimination in the Southern states in the early 1950s because they made active resistance too dangerous, ensuring daily compliance.*

Question 3(a): Source Utility (8 Marks)

Target: AO3 (8 marks). Assess content utility, verify with contextual knowledge, and evaluate provenance reliability and limitations for BOTH sources.

Source B is highly useful for demonstrating the legal litigation strategy of the NAACP. The content highlights how their legal campaigns are "yielding significant results" by targeting segregated institutions, allowing them to successfully challenge segregation in courts. This content is highly useful because it is supported by my contextual knowledge that the NAACP won the Brown v. Board of Education case in 1954, declaring segregated schools unconstitutional, and had previously won Sweatt v. Painter in 1950, which confirms that their legal strategy successfully dismantled segregation's constitutional basis. The provenance makes the source more useful because it is an internal, private memo written by a leading NAACP attorney in 1953. Since it was not intended for public propaganda, it represents a highly reliable, realistic assessment of NAACP strategy and confidence just before their major legal victories.

Source C is highly useful for showing the direct action methods of CORE and the severe grassroots opposition they faced. The activist describes a demonstration at a local department store restaurant but being met with a hostile crowd that subjected them to insults, physical assault, and police amusement. This content's utility is supported by my knowledge that CORE pioneered non-violent direct action, including lunch counter sit-ins, in Northern and Midwestern cities in the 1940s and 1950s, though they faced intense local resistance, which verifies that changing federal laws did not automatically protect activists from local hostility. The provenance increases its usefulness because it is a first-hand account by a CORE volunteer published in a contemporary bulletin in 1952. While the bulletin was designed to motivate members, which might emphasize the drama, it is extremely useful for revealing the immediate physical dangers, emotional frustrations, and reliance on alternative media to publicize their struggle.

Question 3(b): Difference Between Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Identify the main difference of view, supported by details from both interpretations.

The main difference is that Interpretation 1 argues the work of civil rights organisations was highly successful, stating they achieved **"critical legal milestones"** by destroying the legal foundations of segregation. In contrast, Interpretation 2 argues their work made very little practical difference, stating that the day-to-day conditions **"remained virtually unaltered"** because legal victories in court were ultimately ignored by violent white opposition.

Question 3(c): Reason for Difference in Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Explain how the historians may have relied on different sources to reach their views.

The interpretations differ because the historians have given weight to different sources. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which states that they have "successfully outlawed the exclusionary white primary system in Texas", leading to the view that civil rights organisations achieved **"critical legal milestones"** in the courts. Conversely, Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which states that "federal policy adjustments do not automatically dissolve local hostility", leading to the view that **"day-to-day conditions for Southern Black Americans remained virtually unaltered"** on the ground.

Question 3(d): Evaluation of Interpretation (16 Marks + 4 SPaG)

Target: AO4 (16 marks) + SPaG (4 marks). Level 4 (13–16 marks): Balanced discussion analyzing both interpretations with sustained contextual knowledge, leading to a justified judgment.

I agree with Interpretation 2 that practical progress was extremely limited. My own knowledge confirms that despite **NAACP** legal efforts, only roughly **20%** of Southern Black Americans could register to vote due to the **KKK**'s terror tactics and the complicity of local law enforcement. Furthermore, Source C reveals activists endured **insults, physical assault** while local **law enforcement officers watched with amusement**, showing the extreme resistance. This confirms Interpretation 2's claim that day-to-day conditions **"remained virtually unaltered"** and that **"power on the ground was maintained by hostile white groups"**.

However, Interpretation 1 is also valid in stating that the legal foundations were successfully challenged. The **NAACP**'s strategy of litigation culminated in the monumental **1954 Brown v. Topeka** ruling, which officially overturned the **1896 Plessy** doctrine of separate but equal. Furthermore, Source B highlights that litigation was successfully **targeting segregation in higher education** and the **white primary system in Texas**. This matches Interpretation 1's view that they achieved **"critical legal milestones"** that provided **"a crucial legal precedent"** that followed.

*Overall, while Interpretation 1 correctly identifies that the **NAACP** laid the crucial legal groundwork, Interpretation 2 is ultimately stronger for this early period. Until the mass grassroots movements of the **1960s** forced the federal government to physically enforce these new laws, the daily reality of Black Americans **"remained virtually unaltered"**.*